MODULE 3 · KNOW YOUR SCHEMES

# Scholarships, Internships & Savings

**StreetSmarter** : Because no one taught us this stuff www.streetsmarter.in

There's real government money and real opportunity sitting behind a few portals most teenagers never open. This one's about three of them: getting a scholarship, landing a government-backed internship, and a savings scheme worth knowing about even if it's not for you directly, yet.

## 1. Scholarships: The National Scholarship Portal

Instead of hunting down scholarships one by one, India has a single government portal that lists hundreds of them, central and state-level, in one place.

- The National Scholarship Portal (NSP) covers scholarships from multiple ministries, for school students, college students, and specific categories like SC/ST/OBC, minorities, and students with disabilities.
- You'll need a One Time Registration (OTR), generated using your Aadhaar. Do this once, and it stays linked to you for your entire academic career.
- Common documents needed: Aadhaar, bank account details linked to Aadhaar, recent marksheets, and an income certificate (caste certificate too, where relevant).
- Applications typically open mid-year and close around October, but exact dates shift annually, so check the portal directly rather than going by what a friend told you last year.

National Scholarship Portal · *search and apply for central and state scholarships, one registration for all*

**Tool Spotlight: PM Internship Scheme**

A Government of India programme that places young people in real internships at some of India's biggest companies, Tata, Reliance, HDFC Bank, L&T, and hundreds more.

- It's run through the official portal, pminternship.mca.gov.in, and is completely free to apply, no website should ever ask you to pay for it.
- Interns get a monthly stipend, a one-time joining grant, and accident insurance, on top of real work experience at a major company.
- Eligibility, exact stipend amounts, and internship duration have changed across cycles since the scheme launched, so always check the current numbers on the official portal rather than an old article.
- You can apply to multiple internships at once, and a completed, 100%-filled profile gets noticed by companies far more often than a half-done one.

PM Internship Scheme · *apply for a government-backed paid internship at a major company*

## 2. Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana (SSY)

This one might not be for you directly right now, it's a savings account opened for a girl child under 10, but it's genuinely useful to understand, whether it's for a younger sister, a cousin, or your own planning for the future.

- A government-backed savings scheme for a girl child, opened by a parent or legal guardian any time before she turns 10.
- One of the highest interest rates among government savings schemes, reviewed and set every quarter, and it's fully tax-free on investment, interest, and maturity.
- You can start with as little as Rs. 250 a year, up to Rs. 1.5 lakh a year, and the account matures 21 years after it's opened.
- Partial withdrawal is allowed for the girl's higher education once she's 18, and the account can be closed early for marriage after that age too.
- Opened at any post office or authorised bank, with the girl's birth certificate and the guardian's ID and address proof.

## 3. Quick Comparison

- Scholarships (NSP): for you, right now, if you're a student. Apply annually, one registration for life.
- PM Internship Scheme: for you at 18+, real work experience and income at a major company, fully government-backed.
- Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana: not for you to open for yourself, but genuinely useful family financial planning knowledge, and one of the best-kept secrets in Indian personal finance.

### A Few Myths, Busted

| Myth | Fact |
|---|---|
| Government scholarships are only for a few toppers. | The NSP lists hundreds of schemes, many based on category, income, or specific fields of study, not just academic rank. |
| Government internship schemes are basically fake or low quality. | The PM Internship Scheme places interns at genuinely major, well-known companies, with real stipends and insurance. |
| Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana is complicated and only for wealthy families. | You can start with as little as Rs. 250 a year, at any post office, no wealth requirement at all. |

## Useful Links

**National Scholarship Portal** · *search, register once, and apply for scholarships*

**PM Internship Scheme** · *apply for a paid, government-backed internship*

**India.gov.in, Savings Schemes** · *official information on Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana and other savings schemes*


STREETSMARTER
BECAUSE NO ONE TAUGHT US THIS STUFF.